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Carrying Out a Security Audit with Lynis

If you are interested in security, you have perhaps used Lynis for auditing your machines' security status. For those of you who don't know what Lynis is, it is a free, open source and extensible security auditing tool, used by many security auditors across the world. Security specialists, network administrators and penetration testers are all the intended users for this tool. With Lynis, you can add your own custom test. This article shows you how.

As many of you might agree, it would be great to have a tool that audits the entire computing system and in all possible ways to give us a detailed report on it. The developers of Lynis, realising this need, have developed this great tool for us. Lynis already comes with a lot of tests by default but it may not have all the tests that may be specifically required by a user. It is currently capable of doing penetration testing, security auditing, vulnerability detection, system hardening, and compliance testing.

Now let us see how Lynis is better than other tools in the market. First, it is open source. Though there are other tools which audit systems but the main advantage of Lynis is that it is a wholesome tool, that is, it has many other

functionalities apart from auditing.

So, now let us discuss how one can add one's own test to Lynis.

First, install Lynis as follows:

```
sudo apt-get install lynis
```

Performing a basic audit

We can perform a basic audit to check if Lynis is working, by using the following command:

```
lynis audit system --quick
```

With this instruction, Lynis performs all basic tests and